Planted Case Study

Helga Gaona

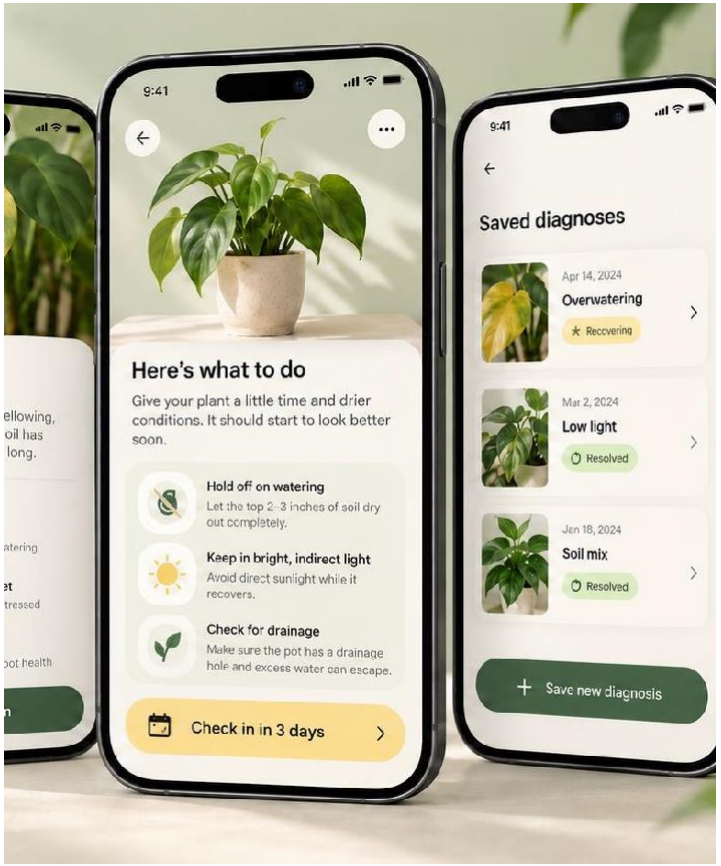
Project overview

The product:

Planted is a mobile plant-care app for beginners.

Project duration:

September 2026 – In Progress



Google

Project overview



The problem:

Beginner plant owners often become anxious when their plant changes after being purchased or moved. Most plant-care apps immediately recommend watering, changing the soil, or moving the plant without considering what the user has already done.



The goal:

The goal is to help new plan owners make calmer, more informed care decisions by considering the plant's care history and explaining when waiting may be the most reasonable next step.

Project overview



My role:

UX/UI Designer and UX Researcher



Responsibilities:

- Defined the user problem and project scope
- Conducted competitor audit
- Created user persona
- Developed problem statements and “How might we?” questions
- Designed user flows and sitemap
- Created paper wireframes
- Designed digital wireframes and future prototypes

Understanding the user

- User research
- Personas
- Problem statements
- User journey maps

User research: summary



I reviewed several plant-care apps to understand how they help beginners identify problems and decide what to do next. I found that many apps provide useful identification, reminders, or diagnosis features but they often give immediate recommendations without considering the user's recent care actions.

This research helped to provide direction to design an app that focuses on helping users understand the situation, review recent care and feel comfortable waiting when another change would create more stress for the plant.

User research: pain points

1

Immediate Advice

Users may assume that something must change right away. The design should explain why an action is recommended and when waiting is appropriate.

2

Care History Ignored

Watering, repotting, moving, or changing the light can affect a plant's condition. The feature should consider recent actions before recommending another change.

3

Confusing Symptoms

Beginners may not know whether yellow leaves, dropping, or leaf loss are normal adaptation symptoms or signs of a larger problem. The experience should use simple language and step by step guides.

4

Many Recommendations

Users need one clear next step instead of a long list of possible solutions. The design should prioritize the most reasonable action.

Persona: **Maya**

Problem statement:

Maya is a beginner plant owner who needs clear, reassuring guidance about her plant's conditions because she does not know whether she should take action or allow the plant to adapt.



Maya

Age: 24
Education: College Student
Hometown: Provo, Utah
Family: Lives with a roommate
Occupation: Part-time student employee

"All my plants die"

Goals

- Keep her houseplants healthy.
- Quickly understand what is wrong with a plant.
- Receive simple, trustworthy care instructions.
- Avoid losing plants because of an incorrect solution.

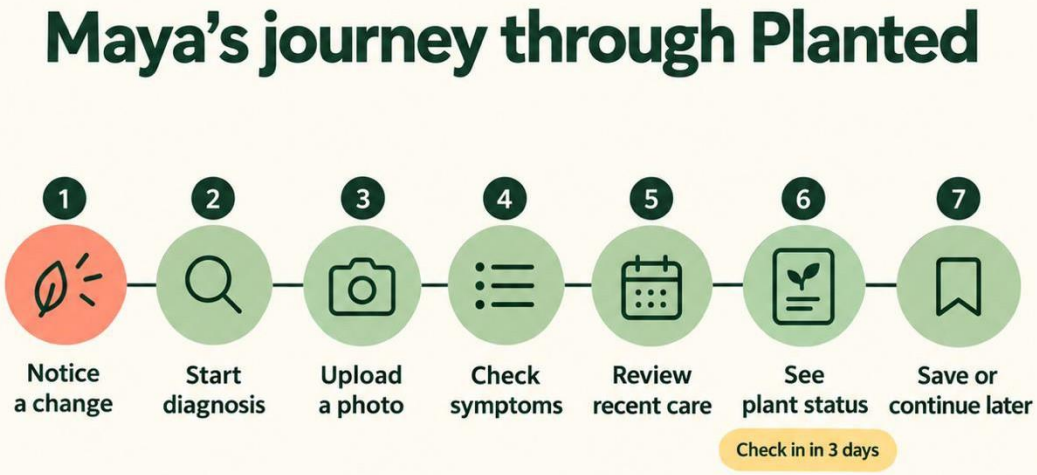
Frustrations

- Not knowing which solution to try first.
- Feeling anxious when her plants look unhealthy.
- Plant problems do not improve as quickly as she expects.
- Trying too many treatments can harm the plant.
- Difficulty understanding how much water or care a plant needs.

Maya is a beginner plant owner who becomes anxious when a plant looks unhealthy. She may repot it, change the soil, or water it repeatedly to help. When the plant does not improve within a few hours, she becomes impatient and may accidentally make the problem worse.

User journey map

The main flow begins when the user notices a problem. The app asks about symptoms, recent care, and the plant's environment. Based on that information, it can recommend an action—or tell the user to wait and observe.

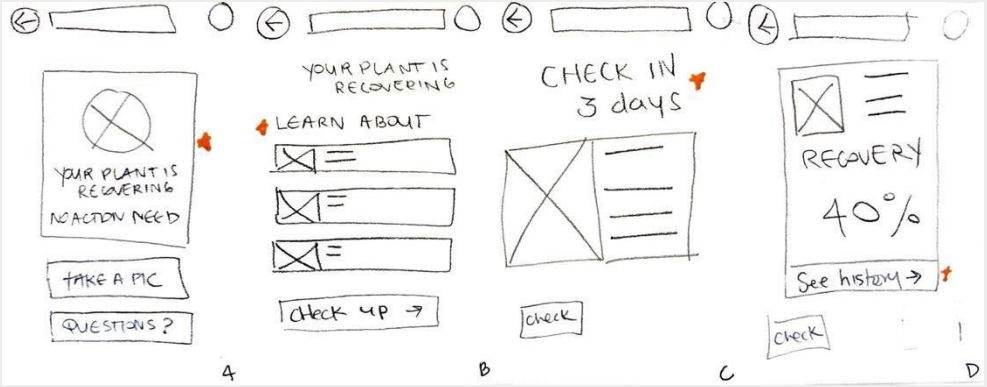


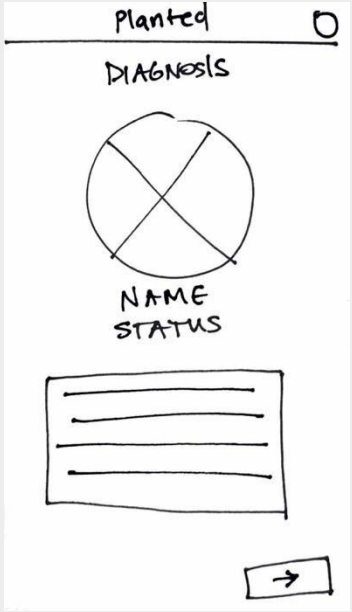
Starting the design

- Paper wireframes
- Digital wireframes
- Low-fidelity prototype
- Usability studies

Paper wireframes

One important design decision was not assuming that the user should always do something immediately. Sometimes the best recommendation is to wait, especially if the plant recently experienced a change.





Digital wireframes

The screen gives the user a clear next step without asking them to make another immediate change.



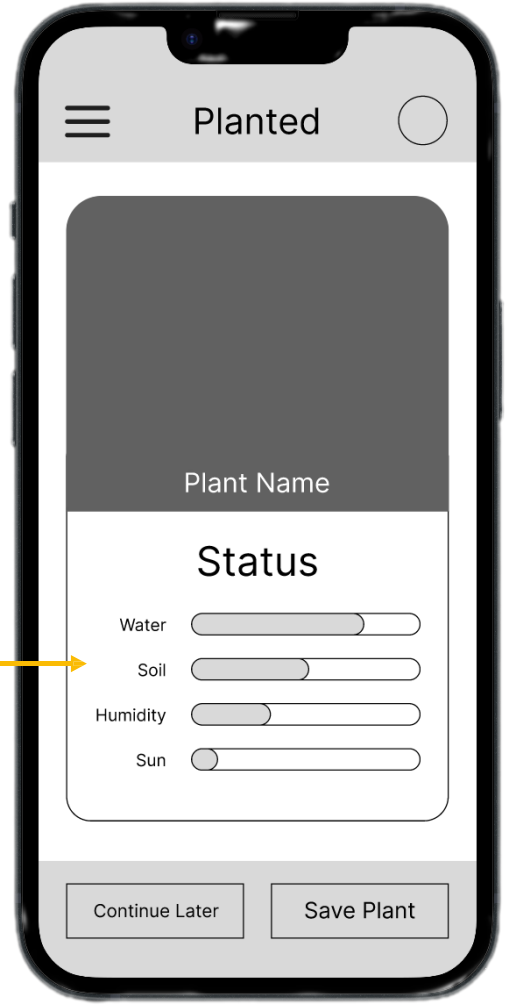
The user receives a specific follow-up time, so they know what to do next and when.

The user can see care history for the plant they are worried about.

Digital wireframes

This screen summarizes the plant's current status based on user input.

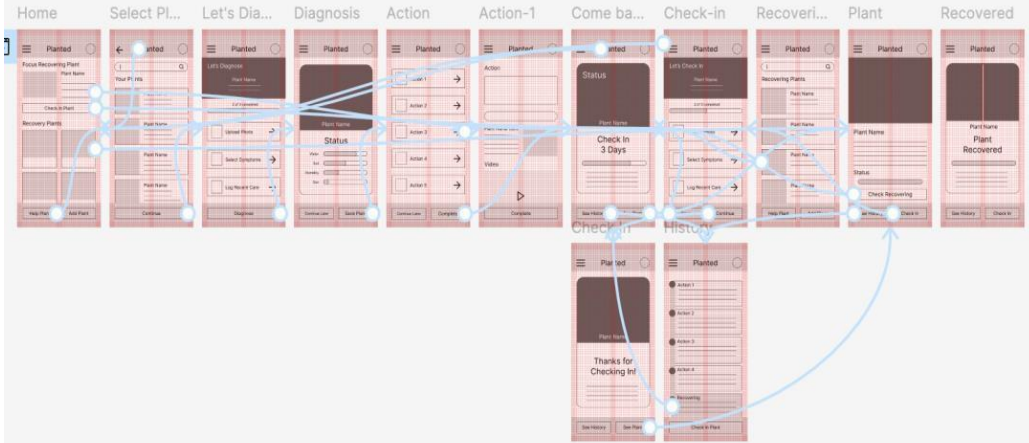
The user can understand what is happening without needing to make an immediate change.



Low-fidelity prototype

[Click to see the low-fidelity prototype]

Maya checks her plant, answers questions about its symptoms and recent care, and receives a recommendation to either take action or wait and observe.



Going forward

- Next Steps
- Takeaways

Next steps

1

Test the design with beginner plant owners to see if they understand they diagnosis and recommendation process.

2

Use the feedback to improve the screens and create several mockup versions. Test the changes again until the flow is clear and easy to use.

3

Create the high-fidelity prototype and add accessibility considerations, such as clear text, strong contrast, readable buttons, and simple instructions.

Takeaways



Impact:

Planted helps beginner plant owners to understand their plant's status and feel more connected to nature in their own homes.



What I learned:

I learned that User Experience is not only about making an app look nice. It is about understanding what users need.

Let’s connect!



Thank you for reviewing my Planted Case Study. I would be happy to share more about my design process and other projects.

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Thank you!